

LittleReads

The Village That Saved Water

Environment

Ages 7–10

by LittleReads Editorial Team

LittleReads

The Village That Saved Water

by LittleReads Editorial Team

Ages 7–10 • Environment

© 2026 LittleReads Publishing

All rights reserved.

Published by LittleReads Publishing

www.littlereads.com

The village of the rain slave Thave. And plenty of water. And they stopped
along the way. It was deep, and the rains came every year.

Chapter 1: The Drying Well

Every morning, the women of the village would go to the well and lower their buckets. But each day, the buckets came up emptier.

The elders called a meeting under the great iroko tree.

"We must do something," said Chief Adewale. "But what?"

Everyone argued. Some wanted to dig the well deeper. Some wanted to move closer to the river. Some said they should pray for rain.

But no one had a clear plan.

Then a quiet voice spoke up.

"I have an idea," said Binta.

Chapter 2: Binta's Plan

Binta was only eleven years old, but she was known in the village for her sharp mind.

"We cannot wait for rain," she said. "We must save the water we have and find ways to collect more."

She held up a drawing she had made.

"First, we fix the leaky pots and broken containers. Every drop matters. Second, we build rainwater collectors on every roof. Third, we plant drought-resistant crops that do not need much water. Fourth, we share what we have instead of hoarding."

The elders looked at each other. The plan was simple but smart.

"How do you know all this?" asked Chief Adewale.

"I read it in books at school," said Binta. "Water conservation is something people have done for thousands of years. We just forgot."

Chapter 3: Working Together

The village followed Binta's plan.

First, they found and fixed every leaky container. An old cooking pot with a crack? Patched. A leaking bucket? Repaired. They saved more water in a week than they expected.

Then, Uncle Soji helped build rainwater collectors — large tarps connected to barrels on every roof. When the rain finally came, every house was ready to catch it.

The farmers planted millet and sorghum, crops that grew well in dry conditions.

And the sharing system meant that no family went thirsty. Those with more water shared with those who had less.

Chapter 4: The Rain Returns

After three months, the rains finally came. The sky opened up, and the rain poured down.

The rainwater collectors filled up. The well rose. The river flowed again.

But this time, Ile-Iwa was prepared. They had water stored. They had habits of saving. And they had a plan for the future.

The villagers celebrated with a feast under the iroko tree.

Chief Adewale raised his cup. "We must thank Binta, who reminded us that solving problems starts with thinking clearly and working together."

Binta smiled shyly. But she was not done yet.

Chapter 5: The Water Committee

Binta suggested the village form a Water Committee — a group of people responsible for maintaining the water systems, checking the collectors, and making sure everyone had enough.

"And it should include children," she said. "Because water is our future, and we need to learn how to protect it."

The elders agreed. Binta became the youngest member of the Ile-Iwa Water Committee.

Other villages heard about what Ile-Iwa had done. They sent people to learn, and Binta taught them everything she knew.

She was not a chief, and she was not a scientist. She was a girl who read books, thought carefully, and believed that even the youngest person could make a difference.

And she was right.

What We Learned

- Water conservation means using water wisely and not wasting it.
- Communities can solve big problems when they work together.
- Even young people can have brilliant ideas that help everyone.
- Planning ahead and preparing for the future is important.

Discussion Questions

1. How do you use water at home? Are there ways to save more?
2. Why is it important to share resources in a community?
3. What would you do if you noticed a problem that no one else was fixing?

LittleReads

Thank you for reading!

Big Adventures for Little Readers

www.littlereads.com